

Hospitality and Tourism English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals

Focus: A hospitality and tourism English curriculum for guest complaints, service recovery, reservations, revenue management, events, vendor coordination, cultural expectations, reviews, and operational briefings.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Situation

A guest arrives early and their room is not ready.

Stakeholder pressure: Upgrade them immediately.

Constraint: Inventory, loyalty status, housekeeping, policy, and guest emotion need balance.

Terms to use

- check-in
- room inventory
- upgrade
- service recovery

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A guest arrives early and their room is not ready.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Upgrade them immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects room inventory.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a arrival recovery script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects room inventory.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	check-in
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Upgrade them immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	We should act now and resolve check-in after the result is visible.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify check-in and room inventory against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A guest arrives early and their room is not ready. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the arrival recovery script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 2. Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Situation

A guest posts that staff were rude and the room was dirty.

Stakeholder pressure: Offer a full refund publicly.

Constraint: Investigation, privacy, brand tone, and recovery options must be considered.

Terms to use

- guest complaint
- online review
- brand voice
- compensation

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A guest posts that staff were rude and the room was dirty.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Offer a full refund publicly.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects online review.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a review response draft.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects online review.

Option	Phrase
A	guest complaint
B	online review
C	brand voice
D	compensation

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Offer a full refund publicly.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve guest complaint after the result is visible.
B	A review response draft is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify guest complaint and online review against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A guest posts that staff were rude and the room was dirty. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the review response draft with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 3. Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Situation

The hotel is oversold during a citywide event.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell late arrivals there is nothing available.

Constraint: Walk policy, partner hotel, transportation, compensation, and empathy are needed.

Terms to use

- overbooking
- walk
- occupancy

- rate parity

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The hotel is oversold during a citywide event.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell late arrivals there is nothing available.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects walk.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a overbooking response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects walk.

Option	Phrase
A	overbooking
B	decision owner
C	walk
D	occupancy

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell late arrivals there is nothing available.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify overbooking and walk against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The hotel is oversold during a citywide event. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the overbooking response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Option	Phrase
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

Module 4. Revenue Management and Pricing

Situation

A corporate client questions a rate increase.

Stakeholder pressure: Say demand is high.

Constraint: Demand, compression nights, contract terms, and value need careful explanation.

Terms to use

- ADR
- RevPAR
- yield management
- compression night

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A corporate client questions a rate increase.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Say demand is high.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects RevPAR.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a rate-change explanation.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects RevPAR.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	RevPAR
D	ADR

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say demand is high.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	We should act now and resolve ADR after the result is visible.
C	A rate-change explanation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify ADR and RevPAR against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A corporate client questions a rate increase. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the rate-change explanation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 5. Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Situation

Rooms are not turning over fast enough for check-in.

Stakeholder pressure: Pressure housekeeping to move faster.

Constraint: Room status, staffing, maintenance defects, and guest promises need coordination.

Terms to use

- room status
- out of order
- turnover
- preventive maintenance

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Rooms are not turning over fast enough for check-in.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Pressure housekeeping to move faster.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects out of order.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a turnover recovery plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects out of order.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	room status
C	turnover
D	preventive maintenance

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Pressure housekeeping to move faster.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify room status and out of order against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve room status after the result is visible.
D	A turnover recovery plan is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Rooms are not turning over fast enough for check-in. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the turnover recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 6. Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Situation

A client changes seating and AV needs on event day.

Stakeholder pressure: Say yes to every change.

Constraint: Contract, staffing, setup time, safety, and vendor capacity need review.

Terms to use

- BEO
- run of show
- attrition

- AV requirement

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A client changes seating and AV needs on event day.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Say yes to every change.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects run of show.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a event change response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects run of show.

Option	Phrase
A	BEO
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	run of show

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say yes to every change.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify BEO and run of show against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve BEO after the result is visible.
C	A event change response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A client changes seating and AV needs on event day. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner

Option	Phrase
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the event change response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 7. Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Situation

Weather disrupts a tour itinerary.

Stakeholder pressure: Keep the original plan to avoid complaints.

Constraint: Safety, local rules, refunds, timing, and guest expectations must be managed.

Terms to use

- itinerary
- force majeure
- waiver
- local operator

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Weather disrupts a tour itinerary.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Keep the original plan to avoid complaints.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects force majeure.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a itinerary-change announcement.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects force majeure.

Option	Phrase
A	waiver
B	local operator
C	evidence threshold
D	itinerary

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Keep the original plan to avoid complaints.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify itinerary and force majeure against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve itinerary after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Weather disrupts a tour itinerary. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the itinerary-change announcement with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 8. Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Situation

International guests complain that service feels cold.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell staff to be friendlier.

Constraint: Expectations, language, nonverbal cues, and service standards need coaching.

Terms to use

- service standard
- cultural expectation
- guest profile
- recovery gesture

Three-step decision practice

Situation

International guests complain that service feels cold.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell staff to be friendlier.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cultural expectation.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a cross-cultural service briefing.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cultural expectation.

Option	Phrase
A	guest profile
B	recovery gesture
C	service standard
D	cultural expectation

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell staff to be friendlier.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify service standard and cultural expectation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve service standard after the result is visible.
D	A cross-cultural service briefing is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - International guests complain that service feels cold. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	evidence threshold
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the cross-cultural service briefing with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. check-in	'check-in' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify check-in and room inventory against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the arrival recovery script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. guest complaint	'guest complaint' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify guest complaint and online review against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the review response draft with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. overbooking	'overbooking' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify overbooking and walk against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the overbooking response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Revenue Management and Pricing - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. ADR	'ADR' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Revenue Management and Pricing - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify ADR and RevPAR against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Revenue Management and Pricing - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the rate-change explanation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. room status	'room status' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify room status and out of order against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the turnover recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. BEO	'BEO' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify BEO and run of show against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the event change response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. itinerary	'itinerary' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify itinerary and force majeure against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the itinerary-change announcement with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Cultural Expectations and Service Style - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. service standard	'service standard' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Cultural Expectations and Service Style - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify service standard and cultural expectation against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Cultural Expectations and Service Style - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the cross-cultural service briefing with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.